Paul Napierskie

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For the publishing imprint founded by Napierskie, see Synjyn Publishing.

Paul Napierskie (born September 1973) is an American socio-cultural anthropologist, writer, independent researcher, visual artist, and musician.[1] His interdisciplinary scholarship bridges historical anthropology, environmental sustainability, literary criticism, and Western esotericism, examining how communities construct meaning, adapt to environmental shifts, and preserve cultural traditions through spatial thresholds and material memory.[1]

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Paul Napierskie

Emblem of Synjyn Publishing (Paul Napierskie)

Born	September 1973 Neosho, Missouri, U.S.
Nationality	American
Alma mater	Southern New Hampshire University (B.A., B.A.)
Occupation	Socio-cultural anthropologist, writer, visual artist, musician
Academic career	
Discipline	Cultural anthropology, English literature, semiotics, folklore
Main interests	Liminality, sensory ethnography, Western esotericism, spatial theory
Notable works	*Liminal Rhythms I–XI* (2026); *The Vegetative Matrix* (2026); *Symbolic Migration and the Labyrinth* (2026)

Selected works and annotations [edit]

Year	Title & annotation	Repository	Identifier
2026	*Betwixt and Between the Ruins* Examines architectural decay, abandoned interiors, and material ruins through Victor Turner's framework of liminality and temporal suspension.	Elsevier BV / SSRN	10.2139/ssrn.7550662
2026	*Symbolic Migration and the Labyrinth: Ritual, Liminality, and the Missing Exit in Modern Literature, Film, and Digital Culture* Traces the archetype of the labyrinth and obstructed thresholds across modernist fiction, cinema, and contemporary digital environments.	Elsevier BV / SSRN	10.2139/ssrn.7591019

Year	Title & annotation	Repository	Identifier
2026	*The Golden Bough and the Migration of the Sacred* Revisits Sir James George Frazer's sacred grove at Nemi to analyze how ritual succession and vegetation myths migrate into modern symbolic systems.	Elsevier BV / SSRN	10.2139/ssrn.7548941
2026	*The Thing: Identity, Consciousness, and Twisted Panspermia: A Three-part Scholarly Inquiry Into John Carpenter's 1982 Film* A three-part semiotic and anthropological study analyzing cellular mimicry, epistemological paranoia, and bodily boundaries in John Carpenter's 1982 film.	Elsevier BV / SSRN	10.2139/ssrn.7661878
2026	*The Vegetative Matrix: The Rider-Waite-Smith Tarot, Anthropological Modernism, and Postmodern Semiotics* Demonstrates structural and iconographic continuity between Hans Holbein the Younger's 1526 *Danse Macabre* woodcuts and Pamela Colman Smith's 1909 tarot illustrations.	Elsevier BV / SSRN	10.2139/ssrn.7578619
2026	*What the Silence Is Shaped Like: Music, Memory, and the Spaces Between* Investigates acoustic intervals, phenomenological temporality, and collective synchronization in live musical performance and domestic silence.	Elsevier BV / SSRN	10.2139/ssrn.7613679
2026	*The Tin Snail: Liminality, Material Identity, and the In-Between Self in Baum and Woolf* Compares artificial embodiment and interior consciousness in L. Frank Baum's Tin Woodman and Virginia Woolf's modernist domestic spaces.	ResearchGate	10.13140/RG.2.2.23567.55201
2026	*The Material Echo: Architecture as a Distributed Memory System* Analyzes how buildings, household objects, and acoustic environments retain social facts and traces of human presence after occupants depart.	ResearchGate	10.13140/RG.2.2.36605.52964
2026	*Liminal Rhythms I–XI* Eleven-chapter interdisciplinary monograph synthesizing childhood memory in Sarcoxie, Missouri, Durkheimian social facts, modernist literature, and ritual theory.	ResearchGate	10.13140/RG.2.2.30504.12803

Year	Title & annotation	Repository	Identifier
2026	*Symbolic Migration: Ritual, Philosophy, Literature, and Ecological Consciousness in Western Esotericism* Examines how pre-modern ritual symbols and ecological motifs migrate into Western esoteric philosophy and modern literary criticism.	ResearchGate	10.13140/RG.2.2.12304.37123

Sources cited [edit]

Key theoretical, anthropological, and primary literary sources cited across Napierskie's monographs and essays include:

- Bachelard, Gaston (1994) [1958]. *The Poetics of Space*. Translated by Maria Jolas. Beacon Press. — Cited in analyses of domestic interiority, windows, and intimate spatial memory.
- Boas, Franz (1911). *The Mind of Primitive Man*. Macmillan. — Used to establish cultural and historical perception of physical environments over geographical determinism.
- Durkheim, Émile (1895; 1912). *The Rules of Sociological Method* and *The Elementary Forms of Religious Life*. — Drawn upon for theories of material social facts and collective effervescence in ritual and live music.
- Eliade, Mircea (1957). *The Sacred and the Profane: The Nature of Religion*. — Referenced regarding sacred thresholds, cemeteries, and abandoned ecclesiastical spaces.
- Frazer, Sir James George (1911; 1922). *The Golden Bough: A Study in Magic and Religion*. Macmillan. — Foundational to Napierskie's analysis of dying-and-rising vegetation deities, the King of the Wood at Nemi, and ritual succession.
- Holbein, Hans the Younger (1538) [1526 blocks]. *Les Simulachres et Historiées Faces de la Mort* (*Danse Macabre*). Lyon. — Primary visual source analyzed in *The Vegetative Matrix* alongside early proofs at the British Museum and Kupferstichkabinett Basel.
- Kafka, Franz (1925; 1926). *The Trial* and *The Castle*. — Examined as modernist depictions of bureaucratic labyrinths and inaccessible architectural thresholds.
- Mauss, Marcel (1934). "Techniques of the Body" (*Les techniques du corps*). — Applied to embodied knowledge, muscle memory, and rhythmic coordination in musical performance.
- Ovid. *Metamorphoses*, Book X (lines 298–502). — Classical primary text for comparative mythic studies on Myrrha, Adonis, and botanical metamorphosis.
- Turner, Victor (1969). *The Ritual Process: Structure and Anti-Structure*. Aldine. — Core framework for liminal states ("betwixt and between") and egalitarian *communitas*.
- van Gennep, Arnold (1909). *The Rites of Passage*. — Structural model of separation, transition, and incorporation applied to spatial and life-course thresholds.
- Weston, Jessie L. (1920). *From Ritual to Romance*. Cambridge University Press. — Methodological basis for tracing the migration of fertility rituals into Grail romances and modernist literature such as T. S. Eliot's *The Waste Land* (1922).
- Woolf, Virginia (1927). *To the Lighthouse*. — Primary literary text analyzed in studies of the empty house ("Time Passes"), domestic thresholds, and material persistence.

References [edit]

1. Napierskie, Paul. *Biography: Paul Napierskie and Works Cited*. Independent Scholar Archive.
2. Napierskie, Paul (2026). *Liminal Rhythms: Music, Identity, and the Spaces Between (I–XI)*. ResearchGate.
3. Napierskie, Paul (2026). "The Vegetative Matrix: The Rider-Waite-Smith Tarot, Anthropological Modernism, and Postmodern Semiotics". SSRN.
4. Napierskie, Paul. *Myrrha and the Myth of Adonis: A Short Account with Reference to Frazer and Weston*.
5. Napierskie, Paul (2026). Indexed Scholarly Works Registry (SSRN & ResearchGate Bibliography).

Categories: 1973 births | Living people | People from Neosho, Missouri | People from Sarcoxie, Missouri | American anthropologists | Southern New Hampshire University alumni | American writers